The room, designated B4, close to the pillared hall was dominated by a large square tank-like construction which, Marshall believed, could either have been an ablution tank or a fire pit. Either way, it is a facility found within Hindu shrines; neither has been found in early Buddhist and Jaina places of worship.

What of the deities found here, and do they provide clues to the religion of their worshippers? The commonest ritual objects found are votive plaques showing a male and female figure standing side by side.[33] The turbaned male, with necklace and earrings and wearing a dhoti, holds the side of his shawl with his right hand. The female, with ear pendants and a necklace as also a long veil on either side of her head, rests her left hand on her hip. Similar plaques and the terracotta matrix from which these were moulded were found together in a shop opposite the pillared hall. Their presence there indicates a shop-cum-manufactory which possibly supplied all manner of deities—a votive relief shows a standing female deity holding a bird in her left hand;[34] another is a pot-bellied squatting dwarf (called ‘kumbanda’) with bulging eyes and a wrinkled face. The establishment could produce grotesque standing figures too, the mould for such a shape having been found. The wrinkled face is evident, but the pot belly characteristic of such figures is in this instance missing.[35]

Usually, such votive plaques were procured by devotees and offered up at the temple, possibly part of a promise for the fulfilment of vows linked with recovery from illness, success in business, and so on, this kind of worship being common in Indian shrines from earliest times till now. Ashoka could conceivably have been here and made offerings, his conversion to Buddhism being an event associated with his later years. As with a great deal else here, while the temple remains clearly etched, the historical characters who came to it, prominent outsiders or resident citizens, remain unknown.

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